

What is Art?

ART is **a way of expression**

It can be described as **a creation** = **a work of art / a piece of art**
an artwork
a masterpiece

Art is **meaningful** = it has **a meaning** for both the artist and the audience.

Art implies **a reaction** (positive or negative) and **a reflection** (the audience has to think, to try and **decipher = decode the meaning**, to understand)

Art has **an aesthetic value** (its quality) and **a financial value** (its price).

There are **seven traditional forms of Art:**

1. Architecture
2. Sculpture
3. Visual Arts (painting, drawing, engraving, photography...)
4. Music
5. Literature (prose, poetry and drama)
6. Performing Arts [= *les arts de la scène*] (dance, opera, mime, theater...)
7. Cinema [the 7th art]

+ three more recent forms of Art:

8. TV and radio
9. Comics [the 9th art]
10. Video games

What is Art for?

What do the artists aim at?

Expression du but :

- The artist creates an artwork **to + BV**
(preposition) **so as to + BV**
in order to + BV
- With an artwork, the artist **aims at + V-ing**
(verb) **intends to + BV**
wants to + BV
- The artist's **aim / goal / purpose** is to...
(noun) **objective**
intention

Artists create an artwork to / in order to:

- **express** themselves / express **a feeling/emotion**
- **introspect**
- **denounce** a situation, the flaws of society
- **protest**
- **transmit / convey** a message
- **share** a point of view
- **tackle** a political / social / environmental **issue**
- **pay a tribute to** a person or an event
- **convince** people
- **raise** people's **awareness** = **make** people **think**
- **entertain** / be **a source of entertainment**
- **demonstrate** a **skill**, a **talent**, the **mastering** of a technique
- **earn money** = **make money** = **make a living** / **make profit**

Art can be found in:

- museums / exhibitions / art galleries
- streets (walls, murals, installations...)
- nature (Landart)
- cinemas, theaters, concert halls
- libraries / bookstores
- the Internet
- human body (performing arts + Can tatoos be considered as a form of Art?)